

SyntaxError: return not in function

The JavaScript exception "return not in function" occurs when a `return` statement is called outside of a `function`.

Message

SyntaxError: Illegal return statement (V8-based)

SyntaxError: return not in function (Firefox)

SyntaxError: Return statements are only valid inside functions. (Safari)

Error type

`SyntaxError`.

What went wrong?

A `return` statement is called outside of a `function`. Maybe there are missing curly braces somewhere? The `return` statement must be in a function, because it ends function execution and specifies a value to be returned to the function caller.

Examples

Missing curly braces

JS

```
function cheer(score) {  
  if (score === 147)  
    return "Maximum!";  
}  
if (score > 100) {  
  return "Century!";  
}  
}  
  
// SyntaxError: return not in function
```



The curly braces look correct at a first glance, but this code snippet is missing a `{` after the first `if` statement. Correct would be:

JS

```
function cheer(score) {  
  if (score === 147) {  
    return "Maximum!";  
  }  
  if (score > 100) {  
    return "Century!";  
  }  
}
```



See also

- `return`



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